

Backgrounder: 31 Brigade Magazine

Short Introduction

Due to the nature of my capstone project, all sources are of a military background. My primary source for information comes from the very Government of Canada website which provides public information on 31 Brigade, its parent organization 4th Canadian Division and its various subunits located across southwestern Ontario.

Equally for interviews, I selected a number of personnel with key roles and specific knowledge to provide advice or actual quotes for the Magazine. Other information was also pieced out from interview sources, information that may be available to individual members from recent operations that may not currently be reflected in public sources. What follows are the sources and the descriptions of those sources from which I will be gathering the necessary info for my Capstone project.

List of Sources with Descriptions

Primary: *Government of Canada website, 4th Canadian Division page, 31 Canadian Brigade Group Page & Subunit Pages*

My primary source of information is coming from the Government of Canada website which provides a variety of information concerning the 4th Canadian Division, 31 Canadian Brigade Group and its twelve subunits located across various cities in Southwestern Ontario. This source provides information concerning the general description of the Brigade and units, it further provides their history and some operational examples. It is a critical source since it provides key information on the Brigade to the public and it is equally where most other sources such as Wikipedia pull their information.

Since my magazine acts as a showcase for both internal and external audiences, it is equally important to survey what general information is currently available to the public. More so, since I must also consider the Brigade and Division's operational security, this source provides actual information on the Brigade, its activities and its members that I can actually include and publish since it has already been deemed safe for public use.

Secondary: *ACIIMS, Internal Army/Military Learning & Training Network*

ACIIMS acts as the Army's internal database and learning resources. It is available and accessible through the military's intranet DWAN. This source provides further information concerning the Brigade's history and current and past activities. Specifically, operational history and information can be gathered from here, especially in concern of personnel numbers and equipment figures. More technical data will be used from this source, however, I will have to bear in mind the operational security of the information and what is allowed to be published. ACIIMS will also provide me with more specific

policy information that will be required for when I translate, edit and publish the magazine, this information is more or less specific to Canadian military operational security and our own public affairs policy. Graphics and images will also be sourced from the website as the Brigade, the Division and most of the subunits have image and graphic databases. Different Public Affairs branches have pre-made graphics that can be utilized, equally, the Division and Brigade have very basic Brand Standards Guides which will be used to source the colours and font for the magazine.

Tertiary: *Combat Photographer, CAF Image Database*

Combat Photographer serves as the Canadian Armed Forces primary image database and contains images from units all over the country. The website has portions dedicated specific to 4 Division and 31 Brigade and will be the main source where I will procure images for the magazine. Images vary from combat and warfighting focused training, to public outreach events, military parades, domestic operations with floods and thousands more examples.

Quaternary: *United States Army Pacific (USARPAC) Magazine September 2023 Issue (Main Design Inspiration)*

This source is not for information but rather is the main design influence for the Brigade's magazine. Very explicitly and on order of the current Brigade Commander, Lieutenant-Colonel Chris Brown, the general structure organization and even some headings are to be used or inspired by the USARPAC Magazine. This magazine, though of a much larger scope than that of the Brigade, provides a useful structure and headers that will be reflected in my own magazine. For example, including a foreword followed by our mission and values statements. Or as another example, the inclusion of a map covering the Ontario Area of Operations denoting the Brigade's responsibilities.

Interview Source List

Lieutenant Paul Verheye, 31 Brigade Public Affairs Officer.

Paul Verheye is the current acting Brigade Public Affairs Officer. In charge of 31 Brigade Communications operations, Lt. Verheye oversees public outreach activities for the Brigade, as well as managing and creating their social media content. He is my boss and is the main source regarding policy. He is currently directly overseeing this project and will be the final check for edits and publishing. He and I will be overseeing publication and will be presenting this product before the Brigade Commander, LCol. Chris Brown. When the magazine is published, Verheye will act as the main source for media inquiries and future continued publication of the magazine.

Sergeant Ziyad Khan, 31 Canadian Brigade Group Staff NCO.

Highly experienced NCO (non-commissioned officer) with the Brigade, Ziyad has recent and significant operational experience with Operation UNIFIER, working and training Ukrainian Armed Forces. He will be relevant to my research as he can provide information on concurrent operations, as well provide relevant firsthand experience for the content within the magazine. Sergeant Khan will also be utilized as a testing audience before the Magazine is published for the Brigade by September 2024.

Sergeant Julian Porcher, *31 Canadian Brigade Group Training Sergeant and “Unofficial” Brigade Historian.*

Sergeant Julian Porcher is arguably one of the most knowledgeable and experienced leaders with the Brigade. He works as the Brigade’s primary training sergeant and has therefore worked with countless different units and personnel from across the Brigade and Division. With nearly two decades of experience, Porcher can provide a variety of technical knowledge concerning Brigade history, operational activities and concurrent training methodologies. Similar to Khan, Sgt. Porcher will also act as a member of the testing audience, providing valuable feedback and points to improve before the Magazine is officially published with the Brigade, sometime in December, date to be decided.